



Game Guides feature on Steam

"Games Guides", a new feature in Steam Community Beta will now enable users to Create and Publish guides on Steam Games

Zuckerberg donates \$500 mn

The Silicon Valley Community Foundation got a charity of 18 Million company shares from Zuckerberg and his Wife Priscilla Chan, worth \$500 million.

Zync Z1000

The budget iPad replacement

Placed next to an iPad, the length and breadth of the Zync Z1000 appears to be the same to the naked eye. It is however thicker than the iPad. The front of the tablet is clean with no physical buttons. All the ports are neatly laid out on one side. A SIM card slot rests behind the HDMI port. The tablet weighs around 650 gm putting it on the heavier side of things.

Straight out of the box, the Zync Z1000 runs on Android 4.0.4 ICS. The official product website claims that it can be upgraded to 4.1 Jelly Bean.

The resolution of the display is better than the Funbook Pro at 1024x768. The representation of colours was nice and we were quite happy watching movies on the device. Having said that, the device is very reflective



Price
₹10,990

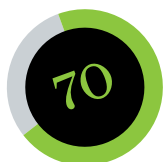
and susceptible to a lot of glare. The viewing angles aren't the best either. All video file formats ran well on it. Since it has a 4:3 aspect ratio, there is a lot of screen real estate that is wasted because of the black bars.

The audio output from the device was surprisingly good. At full volume, there was little distortion and the audio is quite decently clear.

Games on the Z1000 were fun and the device ran all the games we installed from the Play store. Games such as *Angry Birds Star Wars* make good use of the screen's real estate. Browsing the web on the large display too is nice. A whopping 7000mAh battery powers the tablet and it lasts for about 6 hours in continuous video playback.

There are a lot of 7-inch tablets available in the market that perform better than the Zync Z1000 and are cheaper as well. But if a large display is your requirement, then you can consider this device.

Sameer Mitha



Features60
Performance.....80
Build quality60
Value for money.....80

Specifications

Processor: 1.5Ghz processor; **RAM:** 1GB; **Display:** 9.7-inch display (1024 x 768 pixel); **Storage:** 8GB expandable up to 32GB via MicroSD card; **OS:** Android 4.0; Camera 2MP

Contact

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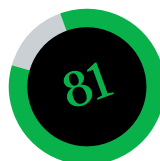
Panasonic DMP-BDT220

The 2D to 3D up-conversion makes this a must-have



Price
₹11,990

Panasonic DMP-BDT220 is the latest Blu-ray player that has a unique offering of upscaling from 2D to 3D. Looks fairly basic but the metal chassis makes this strong enough. The interface is not the most eye catching. Navigation and selection by using the direction keys on the remote takes some getting used to. In terms of performance, the BDT220 is brilliant. It scores very highly in the HQV tests run across all rivals and pips even the Samsung BD-E6500 in terms of sharpness. Upscaling of Blu-rays from 2D to 3D works very well – very good depth, no ghosting and on the fly up-conversion. The BDT220 is a great option anyone who wants a Blu-ray player and already owns a 3D TV.



Features75
Performance.....90
Build Quality75
Value for money.....85

Specifications

Type: Blu-ray player; **3D playback:** Yes; **Up-convert from 2D to 3D:** Yes; **Ports:** HDMI-out, optical audio, USB port; **Connectivity:** Built-in Wi-Fi

Contact

Panasonic India
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Sony BDP-S490

Lack of integrated Wi-Fi is confusing



Price
₹13,990

Sony updated its Blu-ray player range recently and have made more codecs compatible with the devices. When we had tested the BDP-S380 earlier, this was the biggest issue we faced – quite a few popular video formats would refuse to play. This one played back all formats we threw at it – be it off a DVD or a USB drive. It's very well built and the materials used are premium. The test scores lagged a bit because the S490 showed up some loss of clarity during some fast motion shots, but the sharpness and colour handling is very impressive. The performance is okay to justify the price tag, but the lack of integrated Wi-Fi is very surprising. Consider the Panasonic BD220 or the Philips BDP5200.



Features65
Performance.....75
Build Quality80
Value for money.....55

Specifications

Type: Blu-ray player; **3D playback:** Yes; **Ports:** HDMI-out, optical audio, USB port; **Connectivity:** Ethernet, with optional Wi-Fi dongle

Contact

Sony India
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